

similar, only much bigger, assault, spearheaded by Hancock's Second Corps. The target would be the apex of the salient.



General John Sedgwick

Union Sixth Corps commander General John Sedgwick famously chided troops scurrying for cover from snipers with the words: "They can't hit an elephant at this range." Moments later, he was fatally wounded.

The Union assault

Dawn on May 12 brought more rain, along with a mist so thick that the Confederates manning the apex defenses barely heard the tramp and splash of innumerable feet until some 20,000 Union soldiers were upon them. If faulty intelligence had not persuaded Lee to remove 22 cannon from the salient, and if many of its defenders